

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do we remove moisture from fruits and vegetables when drying them?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To stop bacteria and mold from growing

FUN FACT

Removing water keeps dried food safe and lasts a really long time!

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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What temperature should you keep your dehydrator at when drying fruit leathers?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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ANSWER

About 140°F

FUN FACT

You can test dryness by touching the fruit leather and it shouldn't leave a mark.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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What must happen to jerky after drying to make it safe to eat?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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ANSWER

Heat it in an oven at 275°F for 10 minutes

FUN FACT

Heating jerky kills germs that drying alone might miss!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely

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Q

**Why do we salt fish
before smoking it?**

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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ANSWER

To keep harmful bacteria from growing

FUN FACT

The salt makes fish safer to eat after smoking by stopping bad germs.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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What is a pellicle on smoked fish?

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ANSWER

A shiny, slightly sticky skin that helps smoke stick

FUN FACT

The pellicle lets the smoky flavor soak in evenly on the fish.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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What happens if you don't heat smoked fish to at least 150°F?

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ANSWER

Harmful bacteria can stay alive and make you sick

FUN FACT

Cooked fish safer to eat means happier tummies!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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How long does it usually take to dry fruit leather in a dehydrator at 140°F?

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ANSWER

About 10 hours

FUN FACT

Drying times change if the air around you is very humid or dry!

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs

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Q

Why is it important to use uniform size pieces of fish when brining before smoking?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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ANSWER

So all pieces get the same amount of salt

FUN FACT

Equal sizes help the fish salt evenly and stay safe to eat.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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What is the main reason jerky doesn't need to be refrigerated if prepared safely?

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ANSWER

Most moisture is removed so bacteria can't grow

FUN FACT

Without water, bad germs can't live on jerky!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely

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Why is grinding meat risky when making jerky?

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ANSWER

Because grinding spreads germs throughout the meat

FUN FACT

Whole strips are easier to keep safe than ground meats for jerky.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely

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What is one safe method to make jerky at home besides drying?

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ANSWER

Precooking the meat before drying

FUN FACT

Cooking first helps kill germs in the meat before drying.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely

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What type of salt should be used for brining fish before smoking?

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ANSWER

Non-iodized table salt with no anticaking agent

FUN FACT

The right salt mix helps the fish get salty safely and evenly.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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What is an important storage tip for dried fruits and vegetables?

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ANSWER

Keep them in a cool, dark, and dry place

FUN FACT

Light and heat can spoil dried food faster.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables

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Q

Which step helps ensure dried jerky is completely safe before storing?

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ANSWER

Conditioning by storing it in a jar for a few days

FUN FACT

Conditioning helps even out moisture before storing jerky.

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely

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What happens if fish pieces overlap while brining?

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ANSWER

**Salt won't soak in evenly,
risking spoilage**

FUN FACT

*Fish pieces need space to get the
right salty flavor all the way through.*

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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What is the main reason we use smoke when smoking fish and meat?

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ANSWER

Smoke helps preserve and add flavor

FUN FACT

Smoke also adds a cool flavor to your fish or meat!

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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What should you do after drying fruit leather but before rolling it up?

DEHYDRATING AND SMOKING

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ANSWER

Peel it off the drying trays while still warm

FUN FACT

Peeling warm leather helps keep it soft and flexible.

Source: SP 50-921 Drying herbs

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Why is hot-smoking fish safer than cold-smoking it?

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ANSWER

Because hot-smoking cooks the fish to a safe temperature

FUN FACT

Cold-smoked fish can carry germs if not handled carefully.

Source: PNW 238 Smoking fish at home

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How much raw meat do you need to make about 4 ounces of jerky?

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ANSWER

About 16 ounces

FUN FACT

Jerky shrinks a lot because the water is removed!

Source: PNW 632 Making jerky at home safely

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Why should dried foods be tested for dryness before storing?

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ANSWER

To make sure no moisture remains that could cause spoilage

FUN FACT

No moisture means dried food can stay fresh much longer.

Source: PNW 397 Drying fruits and vegetables